



MISSION STATEMENT

The Specialized Foundation uses cycling as a tool for children to achieve academic, health, and social success.

RIDING FOR FOCUS

A comprehensive cycling program that provides schools with everything they need to get their middle school students riding, including a curriculum, bikes, safety equipment and training. We see positive outcomes when kids ride a minimum of 6 weeks, 3 days a week, and at least 20 minutes per day.



PRIMARY RESEARCH

Measuring brain activity of middle school students both during and after cycling in a controlled lab setting.

- What are the acute effects of 'engaged-exercise' upon brain activity, cognitive function and mood?
- How long post-exercise do the effects of cycling last?
- Do some students benefit more from cycling than others?

APPLIED RESEARCH

Deploying Biometric Assessment Tool to seven schools, measuring 1000+ students, during 42,000 individual rides throughout the spring semester.

Objective: Validate that the target heart rates achieved through the Riding for Focus program lead to positive social, academic, and health outcomes.

ENDORSEMENTS

"The Specialized Foundation is doing the science to empirically measure something many have suspected for years: Cycling improves mood, cognition, reduces depressive ideation, improves focus, builds self esteem, creates friendships, AND makes you smarter."

*Lawrence Kovacs, RSU1 Gifted & Talented Instructor,
Bath Middle School*

"Our students really enjoy riding and embrace each adventure with a positive attitude. Nobody has finished a ride in a worse mood than he or she started and our volunteer adults remarked how much each student has gained in skill and confidence."

Anne Rock, English Teacher, AIM Academy

"Our students, parents and community love the Riding for Focus program. We've actually had families move their students into our boundaries just to participate. I can't even imagine our school without the program now."

Jesse Sorenson, Assistant Principle Payson Middle School

